DIPLOMA PROGRAMME PRACTICE / HL / SET A

Psychology / Paper 3

Resource booklet · 105 minutes · 30 marks

Use with the matching Set A Paper 3 question booklet. The studies and data are constructed for this practice paper.

SOURCE 2

A matched-activity experiment

Eighty adult learners agreed to try a new vocabulary platform. A computer randomly allocated 40 to choose one of three equally long practice activities and 40 to receive an assigned activity. Assignment reproduced the activity frequencies chosen by the first group. Everyone then entered an optional 20-minute practice period with the same instructions and could stop at any time. Instructors could not see when anyone stopped. All 80 contributed a result.

Condition	Learners	Mean minutes practising	SD (minutes)
Choice	40	12.4	5.5
Assigned	40	9.2	5.3

The estimated mean difference (choice minus assigned) was 3.2 minutes, with a 95% confidence interval of 0.8 to 5.6 minutes. No measure of autonomy or prior activity preference was taken.

SOURCE 3

Interviews after optional practice

At a different centre, a tutor invited eight learners who had completed an optional practice session to individual interviews. The tutor assessed their coursework. No early leavers were invited. The same tutor coded the transcripts and proposed the theme “choice creates ownership”. Two constructed extracts follow.

Participant L: “I picked the route with pictures. When it got hard I still wanted to finish the route I had picked.”

Participant R: “I spent ages deciding. I stayed because I thought picking badly would make me look as if I could not do it.”

SOURCE 4

A sign-up study at a community centre

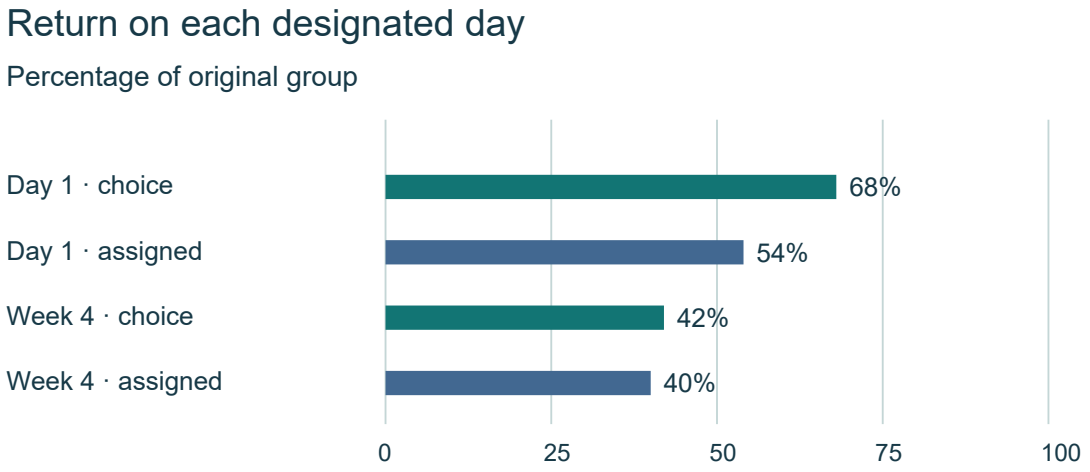
Learners chose whether to join a choice-based practice group or one receiving a set activity. Confidence was recorded before sign-up. Each group below contained 20 learners. Returning at the optional session one week later was recorded from attendance. No group was randomly assigned.

Baseline confidence	Practice rule	Returned	Did not return
Higher	Choice	16	4
Higher	Assigned	12	8
Lower	Choice	8	12
Lower	Assigned	10	10

SOURCE 5

Returning after the first session

At another centre, 100 consenting beginners were randomly allocated in equal numbers to select their first exercise or receive one. Afterwards both groups had access to the identical standard programme. Staff recorded whether each learner returned on each of two designated days. Each percentage uses the original 50 in that condition as its denominator. Returning on both days was possible; the bars do not track the same individual over time.



Constructed research data.